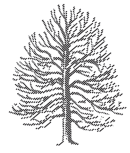
lyuke wmer ra

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in Honor of

Georges-Jean Pinault

edited by

Hannes A. Fellner
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Michaël Peyrot



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Table of Contents

LYUKE WMER RA



Preface ix
Bibliography of Georges-Jean Pinault xi
List of Contributors xxix

Douglas Q. Adams, The dual endings of the verb in Tocharian B and their Proto-Indo-European background 1

Émilie Aussant, The Vyākaraṇic descriptive model and the French grammars of Sanskrit 12

Nalini Balbir, À propos d'un lapidaire prakrit 26

Alain Blanc, L'histoire compliquée de l'adjectif grec *ἀφαυρός* 57

Václav Blažek, A hypothetical Tocharian contribution to Chinese astronomical terminology 70

Joel P. Brereton, How the Gāyatrī became the Gāyatrī 75

Gerd Carling, Flat mirror or well-shaped disc? Tocharian A *tāpaki* (B *tapākye*) and A *mukär** 84

Adam Alvah Catt, A newly identified Tocharian fragment of the *Tridaṇḍisūtra* ..90

Ching Chao-jung, He sat down on the grass under a Nyagrodha tree: On the Kuchean word *atiyo** ~ *atiya** in Kumtura mural painting captions ... 101

Éric Dieu, Accentuation récessive et accentuation columnale en grec ancien, avec quelques considérations sur la loi de limitation 114

Hannes A. Fellner, Polar life in the Tarim Basin 125

José Luis García Ramón, The development of the labiovelars in Greek: Sound change, areal diffusion, and the myth of the three phases 138

Romain Garnier, The PIE word for 'name' 152

Laura Grestenberger, The *ín*-group: Indo-Iranian *ín*-stems and their Indo-European relatives 164

Olav Hackstein, On Latin *arbor* and why *tree* is grammatically feminine in PIE 183

Jens-Uwe Hartmann, Dieter Maue, and Fang Wang, Der neugeborene Bodhisattva besucht das Śākya-Heiligtum: Zu den Bildern 5 und 6 der Treppenhöhle von Kizil 205

Athanaric Huard, "*pattitrukālle kariśkenta wärpanamane*" ou comment honorer un moine tokharien 225

Stephanie W. Jamison, False segmentations and resegmentations in the Rigveda: Gemination and degemination 236

Jay H. Jasanoff, Pre-Toch. **h₁lud^{h}-néu-ti* 'goes out' 243

Ronald I. Kim, Remarks on linguistic variation and change in Tocharian A 252

Jared S. Klein, The Old Church Slavic background of Russian *a* 268

Bernhard Koller, Question particles and the left periphery within Tocharian syntax 281

Frederik Kortlandt, Tocharian B *ste*, *star* 'is', *skente*, *skentar* 'are' 305

Jens Peter Laut and Ablet Semet, Neues zum 18. Kapitel des altuigurischen Maitreyasamiti-Sūtra (*Maitrisimit nom bitig*) 308

Claire Le Feuvre, Védique *vádhri-*, *vṛ́ṣan-*, *dhārú-*, grec **ἔθρις*, *ἄρσην*/*ἔρσην* et *θῆλυς*: Conversion et dérivation 319

Alexander Lubotsky and Alwin Kloekhorst, Indo-Aryan *°(a)u̯artanna* in the Kikkuli treatise 331

Melanie Malzahn, Back to an old, but not decrepit explanation of Homeric Greek *ἐγήρᾱ* 337

Vincent Martzloff, Vestiges du participe parfait en **-wos-*/*-us-* en latin et dans les langues sabelliques? 348

Audrey Mathys, Participes présents, noms d'agents et langue poétique dans *Beowulf* 361

H. Craig Melchert, Hittite neuter *i*-stems 379

Alan J. Nussbaum, Persephonology and Persemorphology: *Περσεφόνη*/*Φερροφαττα* etc. 'Sheaf Thresher' reanalyzed 391

Norbert Oettinger, Die Bedeutung von vedisch *śvañc* 409

Hirotoshi Ogihara, Āgama texts transmitted to Kuchean Buddhism 414

Birgit Anette Olsen, Latin *-ll-* and gemination by laryngeal 426

Daniel Petit, On the secondary cases of Baltic and Tocharian 438

Michaël Peyrot, On a festive occasion: The inflection of Tocharian B *ekṣalye* and morphologically related words 450

Elisabeth Rieken, Anatolische Fruchtbarkeit, urindogermanische Männer und die Wurzel **men-* 'hervorragen' 462

Nicholas Sims-Williams, Chotano-Sogdica III: Old Khotanese *u*, *-u*, *-ū* 477

Carmen Spiers, La malédiction de l'observateur (*upadraṣṭár-*) dans l'Atharvaveda 487

Brent Vine, biass biítam, *valetudinem vitam*: On alliteration in Italic curse texts 501

Michael Weiss, Barley in Anatolian, Tocharian, and elsewhere: A fine-grained analysis 513

Jens Wilkens and Hans Nugteren, Notes on Old Uyghur lexicography and etymology 527

Kazuhiko Yoshida, The Hittite 3 pl. preterites in *-ar* revisited 538

Peter Zieme, Das letzte Blatt der Sängimer Einleitung zum *Maitrisimit nom bitig* und ein tocharisches Wort 546

Stefan Zimmer, Le suffixe gaulois **-ēto-* 554

Index Verborum 563

biass biitam, *valetudinem vitam*: On alliteration in Italic curse texts

BRENT VINE

The rich and varied scholarly contributions of Georges-Jean Pinault are characterized by a fundamental orientation towards the text; and his philological purview has often included "poetic language," a topic addressed in too many of his article-length studies to be cited here, and for which Pinault and Petit 2006 (and the conference on which it was based) may serve as illustration. It thus gives me pleasure—and I hope may afford some pleasure to the honorand—to offer this study of Italic poetic language, as a token of longstanding friendship and admiration.

1 The Latin defixio from Carmona

In addition to being documents of absorbing cultural interest, the late Republican defixiones are among the most important materials for the study of Vulgar Latin. Yet one of the most intriguing of these texts—the defixio from Carmona, Spain (near Seville), first published more than two decades ago (Corell 1993) and the subject of a detailed linguistic study published a half-dozen years later (Marina Sáez 1999)—has so far elicited relatively little attention, apart from these two works and the presentations of the text (following Corell in most particulars) in González Fernández 1996:270–1 (no. 1249), Kropp 2008 (*dfx* 2.2.2/1), and Urbanová 2018:447 (no. 52).[1] Important, however, is the brief analysis by Maltomini (1995) of the ambiguous syntactic "bracketing" of the fourth line of the text (Corell: **sei faciatis votum quod faccio, solvam** . . . , vs. Maltomini: **sei faciatis, votum quod faccio solvam** . . .). As a convenient starting point for the discussion, I provide the transcription of Marina Sáez (1999:293) and a translation (like that of Urbanová 2018:67, 250) that operates with Maltomini's bracketing:

This is a revised version of material presented at the 8th International Conference on Late and Vulgar Latin (University of Oxford, September 2006), at the colloquium on "Strategies of Translation" (Universität zu Köln, December 2010), and as part of the 10th Raoul Bertrand Lecture (San Francisco State University, February 2015). I am extremely grateful to the audiences on those occasions for helpful comments and suggestions. All errors of commission and omission are mine alone.

[1] Urbanová provides brief commentary on selected points (2018:67, 250).

DIs . ImferIs . vos . rogo . uteI . recipiates . nomen
Luxsia . A(uli) . AntestI . filia . caput . cor . co(n)s[i]lio(m) . valetudine(m)
vita(m) . membra . omnia . accedat . morbo . cotidea . et
seI . faciatis . votum . quod . faccio . solva(m) . vostris . meretIs
'To the gods of the underworld; I ask you to accept (as cursed) the name Luxia, daughter of Aulus Antestius—so that sickness attacks her head, heart, judgment, health, life, (and) all her limbs every day; and if you do (this), I will fulfill the vow that I am making, because of your services'.[2]

As shown by Corell, whose arguments are developed and for the most part supported by Marina Sáez, the paleography and orthography suggest a production of some antiquity, probably from the second half of the first century BCE, making this the oldest defixio from Spain, and among the oldest in Latin altogether.[3] The linguistic interest of the text has not gone unnoticed: beyond Corell's preliminary discussions and the subsequent ones of Marina Sáez 1999, note Agostiniani's study of the form **faccio** in line 4 and its implications for Vulgar Latin phonology (1998).

In Corell's description (1993:263), the text is articulated in three parts: the opening dedication to the infernal gods (*Dedikation*: **DIs ImferIs**, line l) is followed by the request (*Bittgesuch,* ending with **cotidea**, near the end of line 3), and the text concludes with a votive promise (*Versprechen,* lines 3–4). It may be added that the request portion is bipartite, beginning as it does with the formal identification or presentation of the victim (from **vos** to **filia**, lines 1–2), followed only then by the curse proper (from **caput** to **cotidea**, lines 2–3). As to the interpretation of the text itself, a degree of uncertainty is introduced by the partial suppression of final *-s* and *-m,* together with the neuter gender of some of the terms for body parts; but Corell has made it tolerably clear that the enumerated body parts and other listed attributes are accusatives, as direct objects of **accedat**, the subject of which is thus the following nominative **morbo**, i.e., **morbo(s)**.[4]

The text displays some unorthodox case usages from the standpoint of Classical Latin; yet these fall within the normal parameters of texts of this type, as with

[2]González Fernández offers a Spanish translation (1996:270) following that of Corell (1993:262); the punctuation of the normalized Latin version of the text given by Kropp indicates that she follows Maltomini's bracketing. I provide the transcription of Marina Sáez (as opposed to those of Corell, González, Kropp, and Urbanová) because of its accurate rendering of the interesting spellings with "I longa", on which see Marina Sáez 1999:295. See further n. 4 below for the sole other discrepancy among these transcriptions.

[3]Other such texts from the first century BCE will be cited below. I find baffling Faraone's assertions that the curse tablets from Mainz (ca. 70–130 CE) are "among the earliest curse texts in Latin" (2006:6), or actually "the earliest examples of curse tablets inscribed in Latin" (2006:9).

[4]So transcribed by both Corell and González. Marina Sáez transcribes **morbo**, but arrives at the clear judgment, in her discussion of the interpretation of the form (1999:298), that the word is more likely nom. sg. **morbo(s)** than dative or ablative singular; similarly Kropp (*morbus* in her normalized Latin version) and Urbanová, with question mark ("*morbo (= morbus?)*"), with the form treated as nominative in her translations (2018:67, 250). (Cf. also the remarks of Marina Sáez on the transitive behavior of its verb **accedat**, 1999:299.) For a thorough discussion of the problem of final-position *s*-loss in Latin, with special attention to late Latin varieties (including some material from curse texts), see Adamik 2017.

the invocational or dedicatory *dativus pendens* (**DIs ImferIs**), or the nominative **Luxsia . . . filia** following **nomen**, a standard "nominative of the victim" (on which see Adams 2003:681). More difficult, however, is the enigmatic form **cotidea**, in the sequence **accedat . morbo(s) . cotidea**, near the end of line 3. Yet despite the formal difficulty, scholars are agreed that the meaning is that of Lat. *cot(t)īdiē* 'daily', and we will leave this problem aside.

2 On alliteration in the Carmona defixio

The curse itself begins with a marked double alliteration, first with a triple sequence on orthographic ⟨C⟩, directly followed by a pair of items with ⟨V⟩: **caput . cor . co(n)s[i]lio(m) . valetudine(m) / vita(m)**. Corell rightly observed (1993:265) that the first sequence is surely intentional ("ohne Zweifel beabsichtigt"), and that the second appears to be so ("scheint beabsichtigt"). Marina Sáez concurs (1999:299), noting the frequency of this feature precisely in the enumerative sections of other defixiones; and she adds an observation of fundamental importance, namely that this feature is also found, in just the same way, in Oscan defixiones, for which she cites the well-known Oscan curse text from Cumae, Ve 3 (= *ST* Cm 13, *ImIt* Cumae 9, *Tab.* 5), with reference to the analysis of its alliterative texture (along with that of other Oscan texts) by Álvarez-Pedrosa Núñez (1997:113–6).[5] Yet there is more that can be said about this feature of the Carmona defixio.

Even if one sets aside more or less "accidental" alliterations, such as those involving physically (and thus textually) adjacent body parts, like *capillos/caput*[6] or *capillum/cerebrum*,[7] a remarkable parallel to the Carmona passage appears, first of all, in the contemporaneous defixio *CIL* I² 2520 (= *dfx* 1.4.4/8), in connection with the phrase *febris cottidiana*.[8] In that text, we find the identical series of alliterating consonants (this time in pairs), in the sequence **corp[us] colorem vires virtutes**. I return below to the relationship between **valetudine(m) / vita(m)**, in the Carmona text, and **vires virtutes** in *CIL* I² 2520; but we may first note that a sequence **vita(m) . valetudin(em)**—identical to Carmona **valetudine(m) / vita(m)** except for the order—occurs in a defixio from Capua (*CIL* X 3824.3 = *DT* 195.3, *dfx* 1.5.2/1.3).[9] We may note first that such two-member asyndetic expressions (often alliterating)

[5]Note also that author's more broadly-conceived study of alliteration in various ancient Indo-European traditions (1994). For an extended discussion of alliteration in Latin and Umbrian *carmina*, see Lazzeroni 1959:134–9.

[6]E.g. *DT* 135 = *dfx* 1.4.2/3 **capilo(m) caput**, 190 = *dfx* 1.4.1/1 **caput capill[os]**.

[7]E.g. *CIL* I² 2541 = *dfx* 1.5.4/1 **capilu(m) cerebru(m)**.

[8]On the probable (in my view) Campanian background of this text, see the Appendix.

[9]For the E's of **valetudin(em)** (line 3) and **tabescat** (line 5) in this text, Álvarez-Pedrosa Núñez (1997:117) mistakes the *CIL* transcriptions of ordinary cursive E (⟨ll⟩) as reflecting an orthographic rendering of closed long /ē̆/ with ⟨ii⟩ (i.e., double ⟨i⟩), via Oscan-style "geminatio vocalium." That this cannot be correct is shown by **Sextiu(s)** in line 6 of this text (with *short* /ĕ/ in this case again spelled with cursive E, and surely not representing, pace Álvarez-Pedrosa Núñez, another instance of closed long /ē̆/). Nor would an Oscan-style notation of this kind be expected in a medial syllable. The only relatively secure instance of ⟨ii⟩ in a

reflect a well-known feature of archaic Italic poetics, as already discussed in extenso by Lazzeroni (1959), though without particular reference to curse texts.

3 A closer look at Oscan: Two defixiones from Cumae

In order to arrive at a deeper understanding of the background of this feature in the late Republican Latin defixiones, it is worth examining the Oscan curse text from Cumae just mentioned, which predates the Latin material just discussed by a half century or so (see, for example, Rix *ST* ad loc., who assigns the piece to the late second or early first century BCE):

	stenim . kalauiiúm . trí	'Stenium Calavium[10] Tre(bi filium)[11]
	aginss . urinss . úlleis	actiones, orationes illius,
	fakinss . fangvam	facinora, linguam,
	biass . biítam aftiím . {**a**}	vires, vitam, spiritum (?),
5	**anamúm . aitatúm**	animam, aetatem,
	amirikum . tíf[eí . –]	quaestum tib[i . . .]'

'Stenius Calavius, son of Tre[bius]:
the (legal) actions, speeches of him,
the deeds, tongue,
strength(s), life, soul (?)/sight (?),
spirit, life span,
wealth[12]—to yo[u I hand over]'.

The text has been much discussed; for detailed analysis of its alliteration, assonance, and other poetic features, see Costa 2000:112–5, with further references (in addition to Álvarez-Pedrosa Núñez 1997:113–6, already cited, and most recently Murano, *Tab.* 5 ad loc., pp. 150–2). For our purposes, it is most important to note that after an initial series of vowel alliterations,[13] the central portion consists of a pair of two-part consonantal alliterations, namely **fakinss . fangvam** and **biass . biítam**.[14]

Republican Latin inscription, finally, reflects /ī/ and not /e̯/: *CIL* I² 364 **viitam** (Vine 1993a:271, following Wachter 1987:444).

[10] Or "Calvium" (Latin-style, without anaptyxis). The Oscan text (as also with another, to be cited below) is conventionally provided with a "translation" (or transposition) into Latin; the version here follows that of Vetter (no. 3, ad loc.), see Buck 1928:366–7 for a slightly different Latin version.

[11] Or 'thrice' for O. **trí** (e.g., Murano 2012:642, see her discussion at *Tab.* 5 ad loc., p. 146).

[12] I leave aside the complex problem posed by **amirikum** (in line 6), traditionally (as here) taken to be a noun, but more recently given a verbal interpretation; see the discussion by Murano, *Tab.* 5 ad loc., pp. 145–6, 152.

[13] A feature also documented, for ancient Italic, in South Picene poetry; cf. Janson 1993, Álvarez-Pedrosa Núñez 1994:197–9, Martzloff 2007:184–5.

[14] There are, to be sure, other phonetic patterns of interest that could be identified, such as the assonating **-ak-** ∼ **-a(n)g-** (line 3), the interlocking sequence **-ss -am -ss -am** (lines 3–4), and repetitions of /a/ + /i/ (**aginss**, **fakinss**, **aftiím**, **aitatúm**, **amirikum**) and /i/ + /a/ (**biass**, **biítam**), cf. the opening onomastic

Now **biass . biítam** is the Oscan notional (and in part etymological) equivalent of Latin *vires vitam*,[15] and bears an obvious family resemblance to the **valetudine(m)** / **vita(m)** of the Carmona text (∼ **vita(m) . valetudin(em)**, *DT* 195.3 = *dfx* 1.5.2/1.3), and also to the phrase **vires virtutes** to which it can be compared (see above), an alliterative lexical combination that appears elsewhere in Latin literature.[16] It has already been seen, moreover, that the Oscan phrase is not to be separated from Ennius' corresponding Latin version *vires vitaque* (*Ann.* 37 Sk); see Watkins's discussion of this phrase as an inherited Italic merism (1995:155), and more recently, along similar lines, Fisher 2014:151–4. Note further, as a new datum in this connection, the Sabellic name *Vībio-* (O. nom. sg. **viíbis** and other case forms → Lat. *Vībius*), which may reflect (according to Weiss 2010:372–4) an archaic Indo-European-style compound name based on **u̯iH-* 'force' + **ǵʷih₃-* 'live'. If Weiss's analysis is correct—and it seems very attractive—it would provide important support for the longstanding association of these lexical elements in Italic phraseology.

There is also, I believe, more to be said about Oscan **fakinss . fangvam** 'facinora, linguam'. It may not be coincidental that in another early defixio from Cumae (*CIL* I² 1614 = *ST* Cm 15, *ImIt* Cumae (?) 10, *Tab.* 4, Ve 7; 1st c. BCE), displaying a form of Oscan-Latin code-switching about which a great deal has been written,[17] there are two features of the victim that are to be affected, first (once again) the Oscan word *fancua* 'tongue', and secondly, another *f*-initial word, Latin *flatus* 'breath': *pus.olusolu.fancua / rectasint.pus.flatu / sicu.olu.sit* 'ut illorum omnium linguae rigidae sint, ut flatus siccus illorum (omnium) sit' (lines 6–8). J. N. Adams has provided a thorough and in my view convincing analysis of the code-switching in this text (2003:127–30), in part as a corrective to the view of Mancini (1988:204–11), among others, that this is basically a Latin text with an inserted Oscan formula. For Adams (2003:130), this is rather "a haphazard mixture of Latin and Oscan," with the linguistic mixing part of a deliberate strategy of obfuscation, a common feature of curse tablets. Yet Adams' minute analysis, which addressed features of phonology, morphology, and syntax, did not consider the matter of lexical choice; and in this respect, I would argue that there is something correct about Mancini's view, since the two central terms of the curse (*fancua . . . flatus . . .*) maintain the paired repetition of *f*-initial words (noted also by Álvarez-Pedrosa Núñez 1997:114), a feature that may

form **kalauiiúm**, as well as regularities of rhythmic patterning. (For early Italic material of this kind, see, e.g., Watkins 1995:206, Vine 2004:619, Martzloff 2007:184–5, Mercado 2016 and 2019.) But we are concerned here with alliteration in its most traditional sense, i.e., C_i- ∼ C_i- (though also including more complex patterning of the types C_iV_i- ∼ C_iV_i- and $C_iV_iC_j$- ∼ $C_iV_iC_j$-).

[15] Oscan **biass** has initial **ǵʷ-*, like **biítam**, vs. Lat. *vires* (**u̯-*) *vitam* (**ǵʷ-*); thus Oscan **b- b-** is achieved (with respect to **biass**) via a synonym of Lat. *vires* or possibly a borrowing (cf. Gk. *βία* 'force'; on the background of **biass**, see Untermann 2000:146, s.v.).

[16] E.g., Pl. *Amph.* 191 *vi et virtute*, Tac. *Hist.* 3.13 *virtutem viresque*, Curt. *Hist.* 9.7.16 *virtutem virium*.

[17] See most recently the full discussion, with references, by Murano, *Tab.* 4 ad loc., pp. 136–9.

owe something to the Oscan tradition visible in the sequence **fakinss . fangvam**, in the earlier curse tablet from the same area.[18]

I suggest, further, that another trace of this material may be found in a Latin defixio from Pompeii. The alliterating sequence **capilu(m) cerebru(m)** in *CIL* I² 2541 (cited above, n. 7) is in fact surrounded by two *f*-words (lines 2–3: **facia(m)** / **capilu(m) cerebru(m) flatus**), one of which (again the second one) is precisely **flatus**, and the first is **facia(m)**, a first-declension avatar of *faciem* 'appearance' (a standard instance of the Vulgar Latin replacement of 5th declension *-iēs* nouns with 1st declension forms in *-ia*).[19] The sequence **facia(m)** . . . **flatus** is conceivably a "Latinization" of the material we have just seen, with *facia* in place of *lingua*—which of course will not alliterate with *flatus*—on the model of Osco-Latin *fancua* . . . *flatu*, and perhaps with influence from phonetically similar Oscan phraseology like **fakinss . fangvam**.[20]

4 "Significance testing" via Latin

Observations such as these face the immediate objection that alliterative patterning is part and parcel of the fabric of Italic poetic language, including Latin "*Sakralsprache*" (see on this point Wölfflin 1933:241), so that the "significance" of this or that alliterative pattern or parallel is to a certain extent in the eye of the beholder.[21] Nevertheless, it is possible in principle to evaluate material like that adduced above, by examining the broader attestation (or lack thereof) of similar patterns. Thus, in one sense, it was legitimate to exclude (as we did above) "accidental" alliterations involving adjacent body parts, given the frequent "head-to-toe" structure of body part enumerations in curse tablets; nor would it be surprising to find some such patterns prominently attested in Latin literature, even in similarly formal contexts,[22] while others appear to be more or less episodic *trouvailles*, as Wölfflin's material abundantly demonstrates.[23] Similarly, for **caput cor** (Carmona) and the **corp[us] colorem** (*CIL* I² 2520) with which it was compared above: it is difficult, at first glance, to avoid comparison with old or popular—and in any case possibly banal—material of the sort *cor corpusque* (Pl.

[18] See Poccetti 1993 on the fundamentally Oscan (and relatively archaic) character of Campanian curse material, and further Adams 2003:139 on the diffusion of this tradition to a Latin-speaking (and in part bilingual) cultural milieu.

[19] Väänänen 1981:106, cf. Lat. *diēs* 'day' vs. OSpan./OPort. *dia*.

[20] Another sequence of this kind may appear in the **flatus faci(es)** (or **faci(am)**) that has been read in a text from Nomentum (*DT* 134B.6 = *dfx* 1.4.2/2), but the readings are very uncertain, and this problem must be left aside here.

[21] I am grateful to J. N. Adams for discussion on this point, and for his suggestion to consult the extraordinary collection of Latin alliterative material amassed by Wölfflin (cited here in the pagination of the 1933 edition of his selected writings).

[22] E.g., for **capilo caput**, **caput capill[os]** (n. 6 above): *caput capillumque,* Livy 1.24.6; *neque caput neque capillum,* Fab. Pict. ap. Gell. 10.15.30; further *caput et/atque cervices,* Cic. *Sest.* 90, *Mur.* 79; *collo et cervicibus,* Cic. *Verr.* 5.108; *madenti coma composito capillo,* Cic. *Sen. Gr.* 13.

[23] For patterns of the sort just treated, see, e.g., Wölfflin 1933:255 on *caput et collum* (Lactantius), *caput cerebrumque* (Vegetius).

Mil. 617).[24] Nevertheless, it is worth remarking that **caput cor** of the Carmona text recalls a quite specific collocation otherwise reconstructable for sacral phraseology, referring to body parts of the sacrificial victim: see Wölfflin's discussion (1933:241) of Cato's witty addition of *cor,* in his phrase *nec caput nec pedes nec cor* (ap. Livy, *Per.* 50), conflating the everyday *nec caput nec pedes*[25] with the sacral phrase *nec caput nec cor*.[26]

For the material with *f-* and *v-* discussed above: there is no dearth of Latin literary parallels, at least in a general way—Wölfflin records more than four pages of alliterating *f-* phrases and almost the same quantity of *v-* material. Yet for the latter, it is mainly the collocation of *valere* and *vivere* (also *vivere* and *vigere*) that is frequent and banal (see Wölfflin s.vv.),[27] whereas *valetudo* + *vita* does not appear to occur elsewhere, and recalls, in its use of the abstract *valetudo,* marked high-style phraseology like *viduertatem vastitudinemque* in "Cato's prayer" (*Agr.* 141.2–3);[28] and it is this that renders significant the verbatim recurrence of **valetudine(m) vita(m)** in the Carmona text as **vita(m) valetudin(em)** in a more or less contemporaneous curse text from Capua (*DT* 195.3 = *dfx* 1.5.2/1.3).

Interesting comparative material can also be found for some of the *f-* data cited above, at least in a broad sense. Thus Oscan **fakinss fangvam** recalls well-attested collocations like *facinus/flagitium* (Cicero, Livy, Tacitus, Augustine) and *flagitium/facinus* (Sallust, Livy, Tacitus). It is tempting to add **febris frigus** 'fever (and) cold/chills' at the head of an otherwise non-alliterating list of maladies in the Latin curse text *DT* 140 = *dfx* 1.4.4/4, to which one might compare the frequent collocation *frigus* 'cold' + *fames* 'hunger', attested from the time of Plautus, prominent in Cicero, and well-documented elsewhere (Wölfflin 1933:261). But it is rather the recurring network of *f-* forms as accompaniments to adjacent alliterating sequences—in both Campanian Oscan and (especially) Campanian Latin curse texts—that seems significant, a type of concatenative behavior that is likewise found, with different consonantal sequences, in the *c- c- c- v- v-* pattern of the Carmona text, which recurs as *c- c- v- v-* in *CIL* I² 2520 (with extensive phonetic and lexical correspondences, as already detailed). To recapitulate the patterns of this kind seen above:

Osc. **fakinss . fangvam / biass . biítam** (Cumae)[29]

Lat. **facia(m) / capilu(m) cerebru(m) flatus** (Pompeii)[30]

[24] Actually part of a more extended sequence (*cor corpusque cruciat*); note further *Mil.* 783, where the defective *corpusque* of the manuscripts was emended to *cor corpusque* by Camerarius, though Dziatzko's *cor pectusque* is now generally read (thus Lindsay, Leo).

[25] *nec caput nec pedes* = (approximately) 'neither one nor the other', hence 'good for nothing' (e.g., Cic. *Fam.* 7.31.2).

[26] Here, however, *caput* = *caput iecinoris* 'tip of the liver'; references and discussion in Wölfflin.

[27] Cf. also above (§3 with n. 16) on *vis/vires* + *virtus.*

[28] On the distinctiveness of the sequence involving alliterating *-tās* and *-tūdō* forms in "Cato's prayer," see Lazzeroni 1959:122–3.

[29] Phonetically tighter than simple *f- f- b- b-*, i.e., [fak-] [faŋ-] [bi-] [bī-].

[30] Note the nearly-pervasive *a*-vocalism.

Lat. **caput . cor . co(n)s[i]lio(m) . valetudine(m) / vita(m)** (Carmona)[31]

Lat. **corp[us] colorem vires virtutes** (*CIL* I² 2520; Campanian?)[32]

Nor is this alliterative technique isolated or restricted to the language of curse texts; it can easily be located in standard examples of Italic prayer language, such as material from the central portion of "Cato's prayer": ***visos invisosque viduertatem vastitudinemque*** (*v- -v- v- v-*), ***fruges frumenta vineta virgultaque*** (cf. the *f- f-* and *v- v-* patterns above), ***pastores pecuaque salva servassis duisque duonam***.[33] Compare, in the Umbrian prayer (Tab. Ig. VIa 52) with phraseology corresponding to Cato's *salva servassis*: ***salua seritu futu fons pacer pase*** (with *f- f-* surrounded by *s- s-* and *p- p-*).[34] The phrase *pacer pase*, moreover, raises a final point, namely the prominence of (naturally alliterating) *figurae etymologicae* in this style, including those with actual etymological relationship,[35] as well as those based on folk-etymological phonetic associations.[36]

5 Concluding remarks

In sum, the alliterative sequences in the Carmona text, though hitherto insufficiently appreciated, are related to precise forms of verbal patterning that are widely attested in the Latin (and especially Campanian Latin) curse-text tradition, stretching back to the Campanian Oscan curse material and the archaic tradition that underlies it, and ultimately comparable to the alliterative technique of traditional Italic *Sakralsprache*. I have elsewhere (1993b) deplored the complete absence of Oscan material in a collection of curse texts styled "from the ancient world" (Gager 1992). The intimate Oscan/Latin relationships treated above provide additional validation for that critique.

Appendix: On the dialectal background of *CIL* I² 2520

Although the series of five nearly identical defixiones originally published by Fox (1912) and catalogued under *CIL* I² 2520 (= *dfx* 1.4.4/8)—the so-called "Johns Hopkins" defixiones—are often said to have been found in Rome (thus, following Fox, *CIL* ad loc., Gager 1992:240, and, though with a query, Warmington 1940:280), the

[31] For **cor . co(n)s[i]lio(m)** note [kor] [kon-] (with sonorants in the syllable coda) or (perhaps more likely) [ko-] [kō-].

[32] [kor-] [kol-] (liquids in syllable coda) [wīr-] [wir-].

[33] For Arch. Lat. *duonam* (for transmitted *bonam*), I follow Watkins (1995:199, n. 4); similarly Mercado 2019.

[34] For detailed and illuminating studies of the poetic features of "Cato's prayer" and comparable material in Umbrian, see Lazzeroni 1959, Watkins 1995 (Chs. 17 and 18), and Mercado 2019.

[35] Like *pacer pase* 'propitious with peace', also Umbr. *pihaclu pihafei* 'purify with a purification-offering', *subocau suboco* (< **subvoc-*) 'invoke an invoking', cf. Lat. *voce vocare* (frequent in prayer language; on *subocau suboco* and *voce vocare*, recently Fisher 2014:146–50), **vires virtutes** (and related literary material, n. 16 above), *fruges frumenta*.

[36] In addition to Osc. **biass biítam** (cf. n. 15 above), plausibly also **caput capill[os]**.

origin of these texts is in fact unknown. Ernout's claim that the language of this text "présente des traces de provincialisme" (1966:102) has been influential, and the position has been argued in some detail by Petersmann (1973:78–9, 85–6). Yet this view has by now been largely discredited—or at least, some of the features on which it is based have been called into question. Thus, the feminine genitive singular forms in *-aes* have been shown to be of no value as an alleged dialectal feature, thanks to Adams' thorough analysis of this ending as a Grecism (2003:479–83).[37] Similarly, an instance in this defixio of a first-declension nominative plural in *-ās* (rel. pron. *quās*, cf. Oscan **pas**/*pas*) is now viewed with skepticism, partly because of a possible attestation of this kind in Cato (*Agr.* 134.1, *hāsce*; cf. Adams 2003:118–9); and much the same applies to the second person singular deponent ending *-rus*, well-attested in Pompeii and other areas outside Rome, but also found in Rome and possibly attested in Cato at least once (*Agr.* 157.8 *experirus*, and perhaps *uterus*; cf. Adams 2003:119 n. 40, with further references).

Nevertheless, despite this prevailing current of revisionism, it may be worthwhile to recall a feature that does not seem to have entered into more recent treatments, namely line-final punctuation. As I have discussed elsewhere (1993a), a number of relatively subtle features of Republican Latin epigraphic paleography may have local profiles, and one of these is the practice of line-final punctuation (that is, the use of word-divider at line-end in inscriptions). I believe I have shown (1993a:144–7) that this practice is quite regular in Oscan and Paelignian, as well as in native-alphabet Umbrian, and that it can also be found with some frequency in Latin inscriptions from Campania, but is quite rare elsewhere. In the set of curse tablets under discussion, this feature is pervasive (1993a:146–7), and it seems to me that this datum should not be ignored. The same feature is found in an archaic Latin inscription from Campania (*CIL* I² 400), in which this practice appears in association with Oscan-style filiation expressions (Vine 1993a:293); and even Adams, in his discussion of this text (2003:136), seems to agree that this paleographic feature is traceable to the non-Latin influence on that text, despite his skepticism about traces of dialectal influence in *CIL* I² 2520. I continue to think, therefore, that we should remain open to some sort of Campanian background for the "Johns Hopkins" defixiones, however that background is to be defined more precisely.

Abbreviations

CIL = *Corpus Inscriptionum Latinarum*. Berlin, 1893– . [On the complex publication history, see https://cil.bbaw.de/cil_en/dateien/index.php?id=5 (accessed June 25, 2019).]

dfx = Kropp, Amina. 2008. *Defixiones: Ein aktuelles Corpus lateinischer Fluchtafeln* (*dfx*). Speyer: Broderson.

[37] For further detail on *-aes* (though fundamentally in agreement with Adams), see now Alho and Leppänen 2017.

DT = Audollent, Auguste. 1904. *Defixionum tabellae quotquot innotuerunt tam in Graecis quam in totius Occidentis partibus praeter Atticas in Corpore inscriptionum Atticarum editas*. Paris: Fontemoing.

ImIt = Crawford, M. H. 2011. *Imagines Italicae: A Corpus of Italic Inscriptions.* London: Institute of Classical Studies.

ST = Rix, Helmut. 2002. *Sabellische Texte: Die Texte des Oskischen, Umbrischen und Südpikenischen*. Heidelberg: Winter.

Tab. = Murano, Francesca. 2013. *Le tabellae defixionum osche.* Pisa: Serra.

Ve = Vetter, Emil. 1953. *Handbuch der italischen Dialekte*. Heidelberg: Winter.

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